Durvalumab 10 mg/kg every 14 days

Durvalumab is infused on Day 1 of each 14-day cycle. The course lasts up to 12 months (26 cycles), and can finish earlier if the cancer progresses or side effects make continuation unsuitable. The first dose should start within 42 days after chemoradiotherapy finishes.

Source reconciled; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending. Selected effects; not a complete medicine leaflet.

A picture of side effects

Numbered symptom boxes connect to the anatomical illustration. The medicine responsible may be uncertain; report the symptom.

1 Lungs / breathing

Durvalumab

Report new or worsening cough, breathlessness or chest pain promptly, including after finishing radiotherapy.

3 Heart / muscles

Durvalumab

Chest pain, palpitations, marked weakness or trouble swallowing can signal serious inflammation; seek urgent help.

5 Bowel

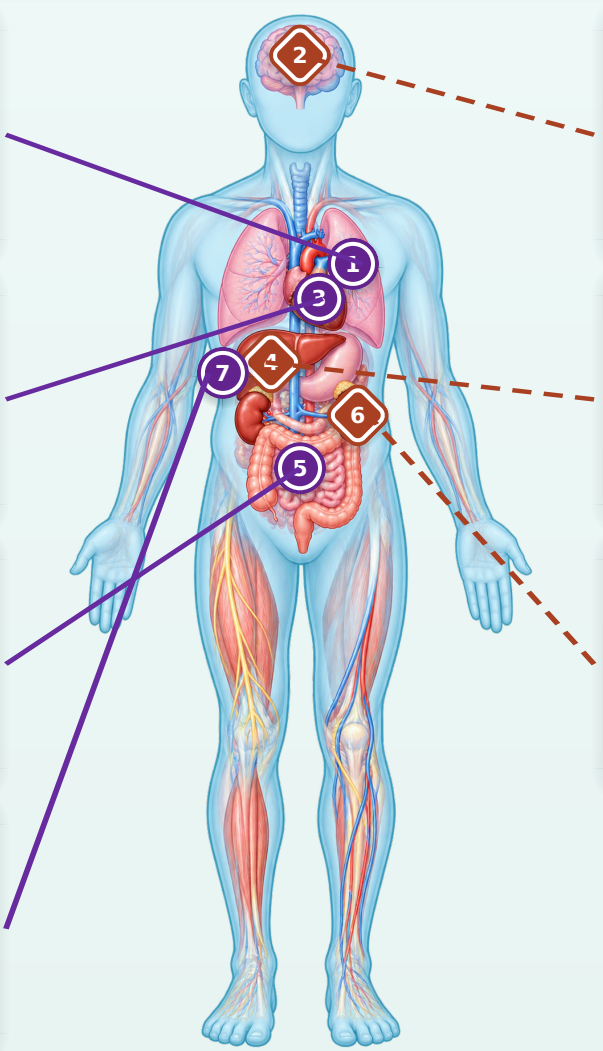
Durvalumab

Report new diarrhoea, blood in stools or significant abdominal pain; do not assume this is ordinary stomach upset.

7 Skin

Durvalumab

Report a spreading rash. Blistering, peeling or mouth/eye sores need urgent assessment.



2 Hormones / head / nerves

Durvalumab

Severe headache, dizziness, confusion, unusual weakness or thirst need prompt assessment; collapse or seizures need emergency help.

4 Liver

Durvalumab

Report yellow eyes/skin, dark urine or significant upper abdominal pain; blood tests may detect changes before symptoms.

6 Kidneys / urine

Durvalumab

Report much less urine, swelling or a change in urine; attend kidney blood tests.

Selected effects, not every possible effect or a prediction. Blood-count, skin and line markers are schematic. Number and text carry meaning; colour is decorative.

These are examples of immune side effects, not a diagnosis or a complete list. Symptoms may have other causes, and blood tests can detect inflammation before you feel it.

Contact the oncology team promptly for new or worsening cough, breathlessness or chest pain; diarrhoea, blood in stools or significant abdominal pain; yellow skin/eyes or dark urine; reduced urine; a spreading or blistering rash; unusual weakness, severe headache, dizziness, marked thirst or passing much more urine. Severe breathing difficulty, collapse, confusion, seizures, rapidly worsening weakness or difficulty swallowing need emergency assessment. Do not wait for the next infusion.

Your treatment, at home.

Important medicine-specific effects

Durvalumab

- Inflammation of the lungs, bowel, liver, kidneys or skin
- Thyroid, adrenal, pituitary or blood-sugar problems that may need long-term replacement treatment
- Rare serious inflammation of the heart, muscles or nerves
- Infusion reactions, fatigue and infections; effects can appear after treatment ends

Surgery, radiation and monitoring: open the whole-treatment map or scan the QR.

Make the plan practical

Immune side effects and the alert card

Immune side effects may start during treatment or after the last dose. Keep the immunotherapy alert card and tell every treating clinician that you have received durvalumab, even during a treatment break or after finishing.

Lung symptoms after radiotherapy

Radiation inflammation, immune inflammation, infection and cancer can cause similar symptoms. Report new or worsening breathing symptoms promptly so the team can assess the cause. Do not assume a new cough is only an old radiotherapy effect.

Support medicines

Durvalumab alone has minimal sickness risk and no routine premedication is specified. Use anti-sickness or other medicines only as prescribed. Steroids for an immune reaction are a treatment plan supervised by the team, not routine premedication; do not start, reduce or stop them yourself.

Hormone replacement and blood tests

Thyroid, adrenal or diabetes problems may need hormone replacement or insulin, sometimes long term. Keep taking prescribed medicines and attend blood tests even when you feel well. Sudden severe weakness, vomiting, faintness, unusual thirst or drowsiness need urgent advice.

Pregnancy, fertility and breastfeeding

Discuss pregnancy plans, fertility and breastfeeding before treatment. Effective contraception is advised during durvalumab and for at least three months after the last dose. Durvalumab is not recommended during pregnancy. The team must help decide whether breastfeeding or durvalumab should be stopped or avoided, weighing the benefits and risks.

Emergency: 112 / 999. Severe breathing difficulty, collapse, seizure or severe chest pain needs emergency help.

Contact oncology immediately for temperature ≥37.5°C or ≤36°C, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell, even with a normal temperature. Follow your own hospital's instructions. If you cannot reach the team, seek urgent medical assessment.

YOUR ONCOLOGY TEAM · DAYTIME

Insert numbers here

Acute Oncology Service

YOUR ONCOLOGY TEAM · OUT OF HOURS

Insert numbers here

Ask for medical oncology

EVENINGS / OVERNIGHT

Your out-of-hours pathway / nearest ED

Other hospitals: use the numbers your team provides.

Complete reference, visual timeline and passport

https://sactcheck.com/patient/00576/

Sources and review status are available online. Follow your own prescription and hospital instructions.